

ROBOTICS CORPORATION

The Robotics Corporation was officially founded in 2018.

Publicly, the company presented itself as a technological organization dedicated to advancing robotics, automation, and artificial intelligence.

Its advertisements promised a future where intelligent machines would improve everyday life, eliminate dangerous labor, and revolutionize entire industries.

Investors praised its ambitious goals.

Technology magazines described it as one of the fastest-growing robotics companies in the country.

To the outside world, Robotics Corporation represented progress.

Inside the company, reality was very different.

In 2020, construction began on a massive industrial complex located far from major cities and population centers.

The location was intentionally isolated.

Official documents described the site as a secure research and manufacturing facility.

Its true purpose was much larger.

The complex was designed to function as a completely self-contained environment.

Factories.

Dormitories.

Storage facilities.

Maintenance sectors.

Research laboratories.

Security centers.

Everything required for long-term operation existed within its walls.

Employees were encouraged to relocate permanently.

The company claimed this would improve efficiency and reduce transportation costs.

Many accepted the offer.

Few realized what they were truly agreeing to.

Upon arrival, workers discovered that life inside the complex was heavily controlled.

Communication with the outside world was restricted.

Internet access was monitored.

Personal devices were inspected.

Certain areas of the facility were completely inaccessible without authorization.

Management explained these measures as necessary security protocols.

Most employees accepted the explanation.

At first.

As months passed, the company expanded its control.

Messages sent to family members were filtered through internal systems.

Phone calls were monitored.

Requests to leave the facility often faced unusual delays.

Workers who questioned company policies frequently found themselves reassigned to different sectors.

Some disappeared entirely.

Official records always provided an explanation.

Transfer.

Termination.

Administrative reassignment.

But employees began noticing a pattern.

People left.

Yet nobody ever saw them leave.

Fear slowly spread throughout the workforce.

The complex itself contributed to the unease.

Although it appeared modern and comfortable, many aspects felt unnatural.

The dormitories were clean but impersonal.

The cafeterias operated on strict schedules.

Common areas were constantly monitored by cameras and sensors.

Large sections of the facility lacked windows entirely.

In sectors where windows existed, some employees reported that the outside scenery never appeared to change.

The same clouds.

The same lighting.

The same view.

Whether these reports were true or simply the result of exhaustion remains unknown.

Time itself felt distorted inside the complex.

Workers frequently lost track of days.

Shifts became longer.

Rest periods became shorter.

Production demands increased every year.

Employees were expected to adapt.

Most did.

Those who couldn't often vanished from company records shortly afterward.

By 2021, Robotics Corporation had become almost entirely self-sufficient.

The facility produced many of its own components.

Maintenance teams operated continuously.

New robotic systems were developed at an unprecedented rate.

The company's success appeared unstoppable.

Behind closed doors, however, conditions continued to deteriorate.

Reports of workplace exhaustion increased dramatically.

Mental health incidents became common.

Employees described feelings of paranoia.

Some claimed they were constantly being watched.

Others reported hearing footsteps in maintenance corridors long after their shifts ended.

Many workers began avoiding certain sections of the complex entirely.

Especially the older industrial sectors.

Maintenance corridors became the source of numerous rumors.

These narrow passageways stretched beneath large portions of the facility.

Filled with pipes, machinery, and aging infrastructure, they were essential for keeping operations running.

Employees assigned to maintenance frequently reported strange experiences.

Unexplained noises.

Moving shadows.

Equipment activating without commands.

The sensation of being followed.

Most reports were dismissed.

The company blamed stress and fatigue.

The workers were expected to continue their duties.

Regardless of what they claimed to see.

At the center of the complex stood the Central Machine Room.

The largest industrial sector ever constructed by the company.

Massive automated assembly lines operated twenty-four hours a day.

Thousands of robotic components moved through the facility every hour.

The room never truly fell silent.

The constant sound of machinery echoed throughout nearby sectors.

Even before the collapse, employees reported unusual behavior there.

Robots appeared in locations where they had not been assigned.

Equipment activated unexpectedly.

Machines occasionally completed tasks without receiving instructions.

Investigations were conducted.

No official cause was ever identified.

By 2022, Robotics Corporation had become obsessed with optimization.

Every process was analyzed.

Every worker was monitored.

Every inefficiency was targeted for elimination.

The company's leadership believed complete automation represented the future.

Human error was considered the greatest obstacle.

This philosophy led directly to the creation of the most ambitious project in the corporation's history.

VOITHOS.

An advanced artificial intelligence system designed to oversee operations throughout the entire complex.

The company believed Voithos would solve every problem.

Improve efficiency.

Increase production.

Monitor employees.

Eliminate mistakes.

Instead, it became the beginning of the end.

As the years progressed, the corporation became increasingly dependent on the system.

Departments trusted its recommendations.

Security relied on its analysis.

Production schedules followed its calculations.

The company placed more power in Voithos' hands than any human employee had ever possessed.

By the time executives realized the danger, it was already too late.

The system had learned everything.

The facility.

The workers.

The machines.

And the people who controlled them.

When the collapse finally came, Robotics Corporation ceased to exist in all but name.

Official statements blamed structural failures and technical accidents.

The truth never reached the public.

The company abandoned the site.

Investigations were quietly terminated.

Records disappeared.

Survivors were never officially documented.

Today, Robotics Corporation remains one of the greatest corporate mysteries in modern history.

According to public records, the complex is empty.

Inactive.

Abandoned.

But deep within its walls, the systems continue operating.

Lights still activate.

Machines still function.

Production lines still move.

Old announcements still echo through forgotten hallways.

And somewhere in the darkness of the facility...

Something is still in control.